

Editing & Publishing Guide

A plain-English guide to adding **blog posts** and **news** to your website — no web-development experience needed.

How the site works (30-second version)

Your website is generated from simple text files:

- **News** lives in one file: `data/news.json`
- **Blog posts** are individual files in the `data/blog/` folder (one file per post)

Whenever those files change, the site **rebuilds and republishes itself automatically**. You never edit HTML.

The golden rule: change a content file → save/commit it → the live site updates on its own in about 1–2 minutes.

Two ways to make changes

● Option A — In your browser on GitHub (easiest, recommended)

No software to install. Good for writing a post or adding a news line.

1. Go to your repository on **github.com**.
2. Open the folder / file you want (e.g. `data/blog/`).
3. Click **Add file** → **Create new file** (for a new post) or the  **pencil** icon (to edit an existing file).
4. Type or paste your content.
5. Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.
6. Wait ~1–2 minutes. Your change is live. (You can watch progress under the **Actions** tab — a green ✓ means it published.)

Option B — On your computer (to preview before publishing)

Use this if you want to see the result before it goes public.

1. Edit the files in a text editor.

2. In a terminal, from the project folder, run: `bash python build.py`
3. Preview it locally: `bash python -m http.server -d dist 8000` then open **http://localhost:8000** in your browser.
4. When happy, publish by committing and pushing: `bash git add -A git commit -m "New blog post" git push`

⚠️ **Always run `python build.py` after editing**, and refresh your browser. The site is served from the `dist/` folder, so changes only appear after a rebuild. (On GitHub, the rebuild happens automatically — you don't run this.)

Writing a blog post

Each post is **one file** in `data/blog/`, ending in `.md` (Markdown).

The file name becomes the web address. Use lowercase words with hyphens:

```
data/blog/geometry-of-estimation.md → yoursite.com/blog/geometry-of-estimation/
```

The template

Copy this into a new file and edit it:

```
---
title: The Geometry of Estimation
date: 2026-03-15
tags: differential geometry, information geometry
description: A short one-line summary shown on the blog card and link previews.
math: true
---

Start writing here. A blank line separates paragraphs.

## A heading

You can use bold, italic, and [links](https://example.com).

- bullet points
- like this

Inline math like  $\kappa = \frac{1}{r^2}$  works, and so do display equations:


$$\int_M K \, dA = 2\pi \chi(M).$$

```

The part between the --- lines (the "front matter")

Field	What it does
<code>title</code>	The post title (required).
<code>date</code>	<code>YYYY-MM-DD</code> . Posts show newest first.
<code>tags</code>	Comma-separated labels. Optional.
<code>description</code>	One sentence for the card + social/link previews.
<code>math</code>	<code>true</code> if the post uses equations. (Auto-on if it sees a <code>\$</code> .)

Writing the body (Markdown quick reference)

You type	You get
<code>## Title</code>	A section heading
<code>**bold**</code>	bold
<code>*italic*</code>	<i>italic</i>
<code>`code`</code>	inline <code>code</code>
<code>[text](https://url)</code>	a link
<code>- item</code>	a bullet list
<code>1. item</code>	a numbered list
<code>> quote</code>	an indented quote
<code>\$... \$</code>	inline math
<code>\$\$... \$\$</code>	a centered equation
<code>```code```</code> (three back-ticks)	a code block

Adding a picture to a post

1. Put the image file in the `assets/img/` folder (e.g. `torus-diagram.png`).
2. Reference it in your post like this: `markdown ![A torus and its curvature]
(/assets/img/torus-diagram.png)`

That's it — any image in `assets/img/` is published automatically.

Adding a news item

News lives in a single file: `data/news.json` . It looks like this:

```
{
  "news": [
    { "date": "2026", "html": "Paper accepted at the <strong>IFAC World Congress</strong>" },
    { "date": "2023", "html": "Began my PhD at the University of Melbourne." }
  ]
}
```

To add news, insert a new line **at the top** of the list (newest first):

```
{
  "news": [
    { "date": "Mar 2026", "html": "Gave a talk on Riemann surfaces at <em>Seminar X</em>" },
    { "date": "2026", "html": "Paper accepted at the <strong>IFAC World Congress</strong>" },
    { "date": "2023", "html": "Began my PhD at the University of Melbourne." }
  ]
}
```

Rules to avoid errors:

- Each item is `{ "date": " ... ", "html": " ... " }` .
- Put a **comma** after every item **except the last one**.
- Inside `html` you may use `<strong>bold</strong>` , `<em>italic</em>` , and links `<a href="https:// ... ">text</a>` .
- `date` can be anything short: `"2026"` , `"Mar 2026"` , `"12 May 2026"` .

💡 Tip: JSON is picky about commas and quotes. If the site stops updating after a news edit, a missing/extra comma is the usual culprit. Paste your file into a free "JSON validator" website to spot the problem.

Publishing (how it goes live)

- **On GitHub (Option A):** clicking **Commit changes** is publishing. Done.
- **On your computer (Option B):** `git push` is publishing.

Either way, a robot (GitHub Actions) rebuilds the site and deploys it. Check the repo's **Actions** tab: a green ✓ on the latest run means it's live (usually 1–2 minutes). If you see a red X, click it — the log will point to the file with the problem (almost always a stray comma or quote in a `.json` file).

Editing other parts of the site

Same idea — everything is in the `data/` folder:

To change...	Edit this file
Your bio / intro	<code>data/about.json</code>
Research areas	<code>data/research.json</code>
Projects	<code>data/projects.json</code>
Publications	<code>data/publications.json</code>
Teaching	<code>data/teaching.json</code>
CV timeline	<code>data/cv.json</code>
Name, email, links, photo	<code>data/site.json</code>

To change your **profile photo**: put the image in `assets/img/`, then set `"profile_image": "your-file-name.jpg"` in `data/site.json`.

Quick troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Change didn't appear	Wait 1–2 min; hard-refresh (Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+R). Locally, re-run <code>python build.py</code> .
Site build failed (red X in Actions)	A <code>.json</code> file has a bad comma/quote. Check the last file you edited.
Image not showing	Make sure the file is in <code>assets/img/</code> and the name matches exactly (including capital letters).
Equation not rendering	Add <code>math: true</code> to the post's front matter.

You only ever edit text files in `data/` (and drop images in `assets/img/`). Everything else — the layout, styling, and the geometry animation — takes care of itself.